

The Code on Social Security 2020 Consolidated, and the Master Numbers Table

Chapter F3.10 — The Closer: Nine Acts Into One Code, What Actually Changed, and Every Number Module 3 Has Tested

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NOTE · HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

The closing chapter of Module 3, and the revision spine for the whole module. It consolidates the nine parent Acts you have met into the Code on Social Security 2020 as a single instrument, chapter by chapter, and separates carefully what changed from what did not. Where a threshold, rate or period moved, it prints an old-Act / Code pair; where it did not - and most did not - the chapter says so explicitly, because the commonest error is to assume everything shifted. Then it delivers the MASTER NUMBERS TABLE - a one-page reference of every threshold, ceiling, rate, formula, time limit and lump sum in the module, arranged by statute and by topic so that in the last week before the exam you have a single sheet to revise from. It closes on the reported 2026 corrections carried into every chapter of the module, on the open verification items that remain, and on how to read this Foundation layer alongside Compact Module 3 v1.1 in the final six weeks. Study time 2 hours 30 minutes.

This is the FOUNDATION layer. The Code on Social Security 2020 was enacted on 28 September 2020 and, along with the other three Codes, was brought into force on 21 November 2025 with Central Rules notified on 8 May 2026. Some chapters remain subject to further State rulemaking and administrative notification. Where a matter is still evolving, the chapter states so and marks the item CONFIRM. Historic and reported current positions are printed as pairs where they differ.

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0. The Closer

You know each statute. This chapter is the map showing how they now fit together, and the sheet you carry into the exam hall.

WHY THIS EXISTS · WHY THIS CHAPTER MATTERS

Nine chapters have taught you the individual statutes and schemes. **This chapter does three things that no earlier chapter could:**

- 1 **Locates every statute you have met on the map of the Code on Social Security 2020**, so that when a question cites "Chapter III of the Code" or "the Code Chapter IX-X provisions on gig workers" you can answer without confusion
- 2 **Distinguishes what CHANGED from what did NOT** - because the commonest error in this territory is assuming everything moved when the Code was enacted. **EPF 20, ESI 10, gratuity's 5-year rule, the maternity benefit's 26 weeks, the Employees' Compensation Act's 2-year time limit - all UNCHANGED.** Recognising that is often the difference between the right and wrong option
- 3 **Delivers the MASTER NUMBERS TABLE** - a single-page revision aid consolidating every examinable threshold, rate, ceiling, period, formula and lump sum from Module 3

The Master Numbers Table is what you should be able to reconstruct from memory in your final week of preparation. It is the single most useful revision aid this manual produces for Module 3, and the entire chapter is structured to earn it.

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F3.10 - THE THREE SESSIONS

- 1 **Session 1 - The Code's structure** and where each Act sits (Section 1)
- 2 **Session 2 - What changed and what did not** - old vs Code pairs (Section 2)
- 3 **Session 3 - THE MASTER NUMBERS TABLE** (Section 3)

Then **40 graded questions**. Budget **three sessions**, about **a day**. This is a lighter chapter by design - the content is largely revision, and its value is in consolidation.

1. Session 1 - The Code's Structure ★★★★★

MUST MASTER · NINE ACTS, FOURTEEN CHAPTERS

The Social Security Code 2020 consolidates NINE Acts, not thirteen or eight. This is a settled examination point.

The nine consolidated Acts:

- 1 **The Employees' Compensation Act, 1923**
- 2 **The Employees' State Insurance Act, 1948**
- 3 **The Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952**
- 4 **The Employment Exchanges (Compulsory Notification of Vacancies) Act, 1959**
- 5 **The Maternity Benefit Act, 1961**
- 6 **The Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972**
- 7 **The Cine-Workers Welfare Fund Act, 1981**
- 8 **The Building and Other Construction Workers' Welfare Cess Act, 1996**
- 9 **The Unorganised Workers' Social Security Act, 2008**

Two remembering aids:

- 1 **The count is NINE.** This aligns with the Code's numbering: Wages 4, IR 3, OSH 13, Social Security **9**, totalling **29** parent Acts across the four Codes. **A stem asserting "the Code consolidated 13 Acts" is confusing this Code with OSH's 13**
- 2 **The list runs 1923 → 2008.** From India's oldest labour statute to the newest umbrella framework, in one instrument

Chapter-by-chapter map of the Code:

Chapter	Subject	Corresponding parent Act(s)
I	Preliminary and definitions	
II	Social Security Organisations	
III	EPF, EPS, EDLI	EPF & MP Act 1952
IV	ESI	ESI Act 1948
V	Gratuity	Payment of Gratuity Act 1972
VI	Maternity benefit	Maternity Benefit Act 1961
VII	Employee compensation	Employees' Compensation Act 1923
VIII	Social security and cess for building and construction workers	BOCW Welfare Cess Act 1996
IX	Social security for unorganised, gig and platform workers	Unorganised Workers' SS Act 2008
X	(continuation of IX, aggregator provisions)	
XI	Employment information (career centres)	Employment Exchanges Act 1959
XII	Monitoring, penalties, offences and jurisdiction	
XIII	Miscellaneous	
XIV	Repeal and savings	

Where the answers live in the Code, if a stem cites Chapter X (say):

- 1 **Chapter III** = EPF, EPS, EDLI (F3.2, F3.3)
- 2 **Chapter IV** = ESI (F3.5)
- 3 **Chapter V** = Gratuity (F3.7)
- 4 **Chapter VI** = Maternity (F3.7 outline; F2.8 substantive)
- 5 **Chapter VII** = Employees' Compensation (F3.6)
- 6 **Chapter VIII** = Building and construction (F2.7)
- 7 **Chapters IX-X** = Unorganised, gig, platform (F3.8)

So a stem "Under Chapter VII of the Code..." is asking about employees' compensation. Do not answer as though it were EPF (which is III). Read the chapter number first.

The Code was brought into FORCE on 21 November 2025, with the **Central Rules** notified on **8 May 2026**. So all Code provisions are operative, subject to further State rulemaking where the Code delegates to State Governments.

KNOW · THE SOCIAL SECURITY ORGANISATIONS UNDER CHAPTER II

Recall from F3.4 (EPFO) and F3.5 (ESIC) that the Code preserves the existing organisational architecture. Chapter II specifically constitutes:

- 1 **Central Board of Trustees** for EPF (s.4 of the Code, formerly s.5A of the 1952 Act)
- 2 **Employees' State Insurance Corporation** (s.5, formerly under the 1948 Act)
- 3 **National Social Security Board** for unorganised workers (formerly under the 2008 Act)
- 4 **State Social Security Boards** at State level
- 5 **State Building Workers' Welfare Boards** (formerly under the 1996 Act)

Note two things:

- 1 The Code did NOT merge EPFO and ESIC. Both continue as separate statutory bodies with their own Boards, chief executives and machinery. **A question suggesting a merger is wrong**
- 2 The **National Social Security Board** and **State Boards** continue with their advisory role - the 2008 Act's framework survives, only now within the Code

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

- 1 How many parent Acts does the Code consolidate?
- 2 Name the earliest and the latest of the nine
- 3 Which Chapter of the Code contains EPF? ESI? Gratuity? Maternity? Employees' Compensation?
- 4 Where do the gig-worker provisions sit?
- 5 When was the Code brought into force? When were the Central Rules notified?
- 6 Did the Code merge EPFO and ESIC?

2. Session 2 - What Changed and What Did Not



MUST MASTER · PART 1 - WHAT DID CHANGE (THE SMALLER LIST)

Nine substantive innovations across the Social Security Code, plus a few consolidations worth noting.

1. NEW: coverage for gig and platform workers. This is genuinely new. The 2008 Act did not contemplate the platform economy; the 2020 Code introduces the **gig worker, platform worker** and **aggregator** definitions and the **1-2 per cent aggregator contribution** on turnover, capped at **5 per cent** of amounts paid to workers.

2. NEW: the aggregator's Social Security Fund for gig and platform workers. Fed by the aggregator levy and administered by the National Social Security Board.

3. NEW: fixed-term employee's gratuity on ONE year of service, prorated. Under the 1972 Act pure, the 5-year condition applied uniformly; the Code (in Chapter V) codifies the special deal for fixed-term employees introduced by the IR Code. **A fixed-term employee still gets pro-rata gratuity at one year - a fact you will have carried over from F2.4 and F3.7.**

4. NEW: uniform definitions of "employee" and "wages". The Code aims for a common definition across chapters, though in practice each chapter still contains carve-outs. **The "wages" definition uses the 50%-rule from the Code on Wages**, which is examined more heavily in Module 2.

5. NEW: harmonised registration. Registration of establishments across the Code is meant to be through a **single online portal** (Shram Suvidha), with common processes.

6. NEW: Inspector-cum-Facilitator replaces the old "Inspector" designation across the Code, though for EPF and ESI this is largely nominal.

7. NEW: penalty escalation. The Code introduces enhanced penalties for repeat offences across statutes, consolidating what was scattered across parent Acts.

8. NEW: career centres in place of employment exchanges. The 1959 Employment Exchanges Act is consolidated into Chapter XI, and its terminology updated.

9. NEW: uniform appellate periods within EPF Chapter III. Although the substantive route was preserved, some appeal-window and deposit-related provisions are harmonised.

And FIVE genuine but smaller changes:

- 1 Expanded scope of certain schemes to family members
- 2 Universal Account Number (UAN) framework given statutory recognition for cross-chapter portability
- 3 New provisions for aggregator-industry-wise social security schemes
- 4 Simplified nomination provisions
- 5 Cross-chapter dispute resolution machinery clarified

MUST MASTER · PART 2 - WHAT DID NOT CHANGE (THE MORE IMPORTANT LIST)

This is where the paper's traps live. Most substantive numbers did NOT change on consolidation. Learn this list because most questions in this territory are testing whether you know the pre-Code answer is still the answer.

EPF (Chapter III):

- 1 Coverage threshold **STILL 20 employees**
- 2 Employee contribution **STILL 12 per cent**
- 3 Employer share split **STILL 8.33 + 3.67**
- 4 Wage ceiling **STILL Rs 15,000** (subject to notification)
- 5 Central Government share to EPS **STILL 1.16 per cent**
- 6 EDLI at **STILL 0.50 per cent**
- 7 **Section 7A's** power of determination substantively **PRESERVED**
- 8 **Section 10 anti-attachment** substantively **PRESERVED**
- 9 **Section 11 priority in insolvency** substantively **PRESERVED**
- 10 Appeal to **CGIT as EPF Appellate Tribunal** with **60 + 60 days, 75% deposit** - **PRESERVED**
- 11 Higher-pension window: NOT open (reported)

ESI (Chapter IV):

- 1 Coverage threshold **STILL 10 employees**
- 2 Wage ceiling **STILL Rs 21,000** (Rs 25,000 for a person with disability)
- 3 Contribution **STILL 0.75 + 3.25 = 4 per cent**
- 4 Contribution periods (Apr-Sep, Oct-Mar) and benefit periods (Jan-Jun, Jul-Dec next year) **UNCHANGED**
- 5 Sickness benefit at 70% for 91 days, 78 days qualifying - **UNCHANGED**
- 6 Maternity at 100% for 26 weeks - **UNCHANGED**
- 7 Disablement 90%, dependants' 90%, funeral Rs 15,000 - **UNCHANGED**
- 8 Medical Board / MAT / EI Court chain - **UNCHANGED**
- 9 Section 45A determination substantively **PRESERVED**

Gratuity (Chapter V):

- 1 Coverage threshold **STILL 10 employees**
- 2 **5-year condition PRESERVED**, with the same death/disablement exception
- 3 Formula **STILL** 15 days x wages / 26 x completed years
- 4 Wages definition **STILL** basic + DA
- 5 Maximum **STILL Rs 20 lakh** (from the 2018-19 revision)
- 6 Nomination and forfeiture rules **UNCHANGED**
- 7 Controlling Authority and Appellate Authority machinery **PRESERVED**

Maternity (Chapter VI):

- 1 Coverage threshold **STILL 10**
- 2 **26 weeks / 12 weeks for two or more children UNCHANGED**
- 3 80 days qualifying **UNCHANGED**
- 4 Adoption / commissioning 12 weeks **UNCHANGED**
- 5 Creche at 50 employees **UNCHANGED** (from the 2017 change; not further amended)

Employees' Compensation (Chapter VII):

- 1 Coverage threshold: **STILL ONE** - no minimum, applies to a single employee
- 2 5-year rule DOES NOT APPLY here (it is a gratuity rule)
- 3 **Section 3 twin phrases PRESERVED**
- 4 **Wage cap Rs 8,000** in the formula **UNCHANGED**
- 5 **Death 50%, PTD 60%** UNCHANGED
- 6 **Notified minimums Rs 1,20,000 (death) and Rs 1,40,000 (PTD) UNCHANGED**
- 7 **Schedule III occupational diseases in three Parts** UNCHANGED
- 8 **Two-year claim limit** UNCHANGED
- 9 **Appeal to High Court on substantial question of law under s.30** substantively PRESERVED

BOCW Cess (Chapter VIII):

- 1 **Cess rate 1-2 per cent of construction cost** UNCHANGED
- 2 Registration and welfare-board structures UNCHANGED

Unorganised Workers (Chapter IX):

- 1 Definitions of unorganised worker, unorganised sector - **CARRIED OVER**
- 2 National and State Social Security Boards - **CARRIED OVER**
- 3 Registration framework - **CARRIED OVER**, now on e-Shram rail

THE HEADLINE, and the interview answer: the Code is more consolidation than reform. **Where a threshold, rate or period existed before, it usually still does. The genuinely new material is: gig/platform workers, aggregator levy, some fixed-term-employee treatment, uniform definitions.**

COMMON UPSC TRAP · THREE COMMON TRAP QUESTIONS

Three specific questions the paper likes to try, and the right way to handle them.

TRAP 1: "The Code raised the EPF coverage threshold from 20 to 50." WRONG. The threshold is **STILL 20**. Do not confuse with the co-operative-society exception under s.16 of the 1952 Act (50 workers without power) - which itself is unchanged.

TRAP 2: "Under the Code, gratuity is payable after 1 year of service." MISLEADING. **Only for fixed-term employees**; the general rule of **5 years continuous service** is unchanged, with the same death/disablement exception.

TRAP 3: "The Code repeals the Employees' Compensation Act 1923 completely." WRONG. The Act's **substance is carried into Chapter VII of the Code**; the Act itself is consolidated into the Code, but its rules on liability, formula, wage cap and Schedule III are preserved. **It has not been "abolished".**

The exam habit for any "under the Code..." question is thus: identify the parent Act the question is actually about, and answer with the pre-Code rule unless the question specifically references one of the nine innovations above.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 2

- 1 Name three genuinely new provisions in the Code
- 2 State that the following did NOT change: EPF threshold, ESI ceiling, gratuity 5-year rule, EC time limit
- 3 Under Chapter III of the Code, what remains of Section 7A?
- 4 Under Chapter VII of the Code, what remains of the twin phrases from the 1923 Act?
- 5 Under Chapter IX-X, what did NOT exist before the Code?
- 6 State the interview answer to "how significant was the Code?"

3. Session 3 - The Master Numbers Table ★★★★★

The single sheet to carry into your last week of preparation.

3.1 Thresholds

Item	Number
EPF - coverage threshold	20 employees
ESI - coverage threshold	10 employees
Gratuity - coverage threshold	10 employees
Maternity Benefit - coverage threshold	10 employees
Employees' Compensation - threshold	1 (no minimum)
Co-operative society without power (EPF exemption)	50 employees
BOCW - covered establishment	10 building workers
Contract Labour - CLRA coverage	20 workers
Migrant workers - Chapter VIII of the Code	5 workers
Creche - Maternity Benefit Act (since 2017)	50 employees

3.2 Ceilings

Item	Number
EPF - wage ceiling	Rs 15,000
ESI - wage ceiling (ordinary)	Rs 21,000
ESI - wage ceiling (person with disability)	Rs 25,000
Employees' Compensation - wage cap in formula	Rs 8,000
Gratuity - maximum	Rs 20 lakh (2018-19)
PM-SYM - income eligibility	Rs 15,000
NPS-Traders - annual turnover eligibility	Rs 1.5 crore
ELI - salary cap	Rs 1 lakh
Pension ceiling under consideration	Rs 25,000 (CONFIRM, reported)

3.3 Contribution rates

Item	Rate
EPF - employee	12%
EPF - employer (total)	12%
EPF - employer to pension (EPS)	8.33%
EPF - employer to provident fund	3.67%
EDLI - employer	0.50%
Administrative charges - employer	0.50%

Item	Rate
Central Government to EPS	1.16%
Interest on EPF FY 2025-26	8.25%
ESI - employee	0.75%
ESI - employer	3.25%
ESI - combined	4%
Aggregator contribution (gig/platform)	1-2% of turnover (cap 5% of payments)
BOCW cess	1-2% of construction cost
PM-SYM contribution	50:50 subscriber-Government
NPS-Traders	50:50 subscriber-Government
Reduced EPF rate (small units, sick companies, JBBCG)	10%
Bonus - minimum	8.33%
Bonus - maximum	20%

3.4 Formulas

Benefit	Formula
EPS 1995 pension	$(\text{Pensionable Salary} \times \text{Pensionable Service}) \div 70, +2 \text{ years bonus at } 20+ \text{ years}$
EC death compensation	$50\% \times \text{monthly wages (cap Rs 8,000)} \times \text{Schedule IV factor, min Rs 1,20,000}$
EC permanent total disablement	$60\% \times \text{monthly wages (cap Rs 8,000)} \times \text{Schedule IV factor, min Rs 1,40,000}$
EC temporary disablement	25% of monthly wages, paid half-monthly, max 5 years
Gratuity	$(\text{Last drawn wages} / 26) \times 15 \times \text{completed years, max Rs 20 lakh}$
Retrenchment compensation (ID Act 1947 / IR Code)	15 days per completed year (excess of 6 months rounds up)
14B damages under EPF (Para 32A)	5% / 10% / 15% / 25% by length of default, max 100% of arrears

3.5 Time limits and periods

Item	Period
ECR filing / EPF remittance	By the 15th of following month
EPS eligibility for pension	10 years' eligible service
Superannuation age	58
Early pension under EPS	From 50, at reduced rate
EPF gratuity's 5-year continuous service	5 years
Gratuity payment after termination	Within 30 days
Nomination under EPF Scheme (Para 61)	After joining
Nomination under Gratuity Act (s.6)	After 1 year of service
EPF Section 7A - ex parte set aside	Within 3 months (s.7A(4))

Item	Period
EPF Section 7B - review application	Within 45 days
EPF Section 7C - escaped amount	Within 5 years of original order
EPF Section 7-I - appeal to CGIT	60 + 60 = 120 days
EPF Section 7-O - deposit	75% (waivable by Tribunal)
EPF Section 7Q - interest	12% per annum from due date
ESI sickness benefit	70% for 91 days (78 days qualifying)
ESI maternity benefit	100% for 26 weeks
Maternity Benefit Act - leave (< 2 kids)	26 weeks
Maternity Benefit Act - leave (≥ 2 kids)	12 weeks
Maternity - qualifying service	80 days in preceding 12 months
EC claim time limit	2 years from accident, death or diagnosis
EC deposit of compensation	Within 1 month of falling due (s.4A)
EC appeal to High Court	On substantial question of law (s.30)
Gratuity appeal - Appellate Authority	60 + 60 = 120 days
APY joining age	18-40
PM-SYM joining age	18-40
PMSBY age range	18-70
PMJJBY age range	18-50
PMJJBY lien period	45 days for non-accident deaths
ELI Part A instalments	At 6 months and 12 months

3.6 Lump sums and specific amounts

Item	Amount
Employees' Compensation death (min)	Rs 1,20,000
Employees' Compensation PTD (min)	Rs 1,40,000
Gratuity maximum	Rs 20 lakh
ESI funeral expenses	Rs 15,000
ESI confinement expenses	Rs 5,000
PMJJBY sum assured	Rs 2 lakh
PMSBY sum assured	Rs 2 lakh (Rs 1 lakh for PPD)
PMJJBY premium	Rs 436 (raised from Rs 330 in 2022)
PMSBY premium	Rs 20
PM-SYM pension	Rs 3,000 per month at 60
NPS-Traders pension	Rs 3,000 per month at 60
APY pension range	Rs 1,000 to Rs 5,000
PM-JAY cover	Rs 5 lakh per family per year

Item	Amount
Minimum EPS pension	Rs 1,000 (since 1 Sep 2014)
IGNOAPS - Central (60-79)	Rs 200 / month
IGNOAPS - Central (80+)	Rs 500 / month
IGNWPS - Central (40-79)	Rs 300 / month
IGNWPS - Central (80+)	Rs 500 / month
IGNDPS - Central (18-79)	Rs 300 / month
NFBS one-time benefit	Rs 20,000
ELI Part A benefit	Rs 15,000 (in 2 instalments)
ELI Part B benefit	Rs 3,000 / month
Annapurna foodgrain	10 kg / month

3.7 Bodies and appellate architecture

Body	Function
EPFO (statutory body)	Administers EPF, EPS, EDLI - Ministry of Labour and Employment
Central Board of Trustees (s.5A)	Governing body of EPFO, tripartite, chaired by Union Labour Minister
Central Provident Fund Commissioner (s.5D)	Chief executive of EPFO
Assistant Provident Fund Commissioner (s.5D)	Your post - conducts inquiries under s.7A
ESIC (statutory body)	Administers ESI - Ministry of Labour and Employment
Director General	Chief executive of ESIC
Medical Board / MAT / EI Court	ESI disablement chain
Employees' Compensation Commissioner (s.20)	EC Act adjudication
Controlling Authority / Appellate Authority	Gratuity adjudication
CGIT as EPF Appellate Tribunal	Appeals under s.7-I
PFRDA	Administers APY, NPS
LIC	Administers PM-SYM, NPS-Traders
National Social Security Board	Unorganised workers, chaired by Union Labour Minister
State Social Security Boards	Unorganised workers at State level

3.8 The five appellate architectures

Statute	Appellate route
EPF	Officer → CGIT (EPF Appellate Tribunal) → High Court under Art 226
ESI	Regional Director → EI Court (s.74)
Employees' Compensation	Commissioner → High Court on substantial question of law (s.30)
Gratuity	Controlling Authority → Appellate Authority → High Court under Art 226
Maternity Benefit	Inspector / internal appeal → High Court under Art 226

CHECK YOURSELF · MASTER NUMBERS TABLE

Reconstruct without looking. Give yourself 15 minutes and try to write down from memory:

- 1 Every threshold (10 different ones)
- 2 Every ceiling (8 different)
- 3 Every EPF and ESI contribution rate
- 4 The EPS pension formula and its divisor
- 5 The Employees' Compensation death and PTD formulas and their minimums
- 6 The gratuity formula and maximum
- 7 The seven principal ESI benefits and rates
- 8 The five appellate architectures
- 9 The five schemes for unorganised workers with their headline numbers

4. Graded Practice - 40 Questions ★★★★★

4.1 Level 1 - Recognition

Q. 1. The Code on Social Security 2020 consolidates how many parent Acts?

(a) 4 (b) 9 (c) 13 (d) 29

Q. 2. The Code was brought into force on

(a) 28 September 2020 (b) 1 April 2022 (c) 21 November 2025 (d) 8 May 2026

Q. 3. The Central Rules under the Code were notified on

(a) 28 September 2020 (b) 21 November 2025 (c) 8 May 2026 (d) 1 April 2026

Q. 4. Chapter III of the Code deals with

(a) Employees' Compensation (b) ESI (c) EPF, EPS and EDLI (d) Gratuity

Q. 5. Chapter VII of the Code deals with

(a) EPF (b) ESI (c) Gratuity (d) Employees' Compensation

Q. 6. Provisions for gig and platform workers are in

(a) Chapter III (b) Chapter V (c) Chapters IX-X (d) Chapter XII

Q. 7. The EPF coverage threshold under the Code is

(a) 10 (b) 20 (c) 50 (d) 100

Q. 8. The ESI wage ceiling under the Code (ordinary) is

(a) Rs 15,000 (b) Rs 18,000 (c) Rs 21,000 (d) Rs 25,000

Q. 9. The Employees' Compensation Act's threshold under the Code is

(a) 1 (no minimum) (b) 10 (c) 20 (d) 50

Q. 10. The gratuity maximum under the Code is

(a) Rs 3.5 lakh (b) Rs 10 lakh (c) Rs 15 lakh (d) Rs 20 lakh

Q. 11. The 5-year continuous service condition for gratuity under the Code

(a) has been abolished (b) is preserved, with the same death/disablement exception (c) has been raised to 7 years (d) has been reduced to 1 year for all employees

Q. 12. The aggregator levy under the Code is a rate on

(a) wages paid (b) annual turnover (c) share capital (d) number of workers

Q. 13. The 26-week maternity leave under the Code applies to a woman with

(a) any number of surviving children (b) fewer than 2 surviving children (c) 3 or more surviving children (d) no surviving children only

Q. 14. The wage cap in the Employees' Compensation formula under the Code is

(a) Rs 5,000 (b) Rs 8,000 (c) Rs 15,000 (d) Rs 21,000

Q. 15. The notified minimum compensation for death under Chapter VII is

(a) Rs 80,000 (b) Rs 1,00,000 (c) Rs 1,20,000 (d) Rs 1,40,000

4.2 Level 2 - Understanding

Q. 16. Which one of the following DID NOT change on consolidation?

(a) EPF threshold of 20 (b) ESI ceiling of Rs 21,000 (c) Gratuity 5-year rule (d) None of the above changed

Q. 17. Which one of the following IS genuinely new under the Code?

(a) EPF at 20 employees (b) The aggregator contribution for gig and platform workers (c) ESI at Rs 21,000 (d) Gratuity 5-year rule

Q. 18. A statement that "the Code raised the EPF coverage threshold to 50" is

(a) correct (b) wrong - it is still 20, and 50 is only the co-operative-society exception without power (c) correct only for factories (d) correct for shops but not for factories

Q. 19. The reason the EPF, ESI, gratuity and maternity numbers largely survived the Code is that

(a) the Code was a mere renaming exercise (b) most of the code's work was CONSOLIDATION of existing law into a single instrument, not substantive reform of the numbers (c) the Codes are subordinate legislation (d) the numbers are in the Constitution

Q. 20. Which one of the following is NOT among the nine Acts consolidated?

(a) Payment of Gratuity Act 1972 (b) Maternity Benefit Act 1961 (c) Industrial Disputes Act 1947 (d) Employees' Compensation Act 1923

Q. 21. The Employment Exchanges Act 1959 is consolidated in the Code because

(a) it deals with employment information/career centres, which is a form of employment-related service (b) it was renamed as the Career Services Act (c) it was fully repealed and replaced (d) it applies only in central-sphere establishments

Q. 22. The Building and Other Construction Workers' Welfare Cess Act 1996 becomes

(a) Chapter III (b) Chapter VI (c) Chapter VII (d) Chapter VIII

Q. 23. The National Social Security Board's role under the Code is

(a) directly to disburse benefits (b) advisory - to recommend and review schemes for unorganised workers (c) to adjudicate individual disputes (d) to file criminal prosecutions

Q. 24. The 2008 Unorganised Workers Act's core framework under the Code

(a) has been repealed and replaced entirely (b) is carried over into Chapter IX, with additional provisions for gig and platform workers in Chapters IX-X (c) is preserved but no longer operative (d) applies only to a limited class of States

Q. 25. Under the Code, the appellate route for an EPF Section 7A order is

(a) to the Employees' Insurance Court (b) to the CGIT acting as the EPF Appellate Tribunal, and thereafter the High Court under Article 226 (c) directly to the High Court on a substantial question of law (d) to the National Company Law Tribunal

Q. 26. Under the Code, the appellate route for an Employees' Compensation Commissioner's order is

(a) to the CGIT (b) to the EI Court (c) to the High Court on a substantial question of law (d) to the National Social Security Board

Q. 27. The Code's Chapter VIII on building workers preserves the 1996 cess rate of

(a) 0.5% of construction cost (b) 1-2% of construction cost (c) 3-5% of construction cost (d) 5% of the wage bill

Q. 28. The Code's provisions on Employees' Compensation preserve

(a) Section 3's twin phrases and the Schedule III occupational-diseases structure (b) the ESI Act's Medical Board (c) the EPF Act's Central Board (d) all three

Q. 29. Under the Code, gratuity remains payable

(a) after 3 years of service (b) after 5 years of continuous service (for the general case), with death/disablement exception, and after 1 year prorated for fixed-term employees (c) after 10 years (d) at retirement irrespective of service duration

Q. 30. The Code's provisions on ESI preserve

(a) the 10-employee threshold, Rs 21,000 wage ceiling, 4% contribution split 0.75+3.25, the six benefits and their rates (b) only the 10-employee threshold (c) only the wage ceiling (d) none of the substantive provisions

4.3 Level 3 - Recruitment Test standard**Q. 31. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:**

List-I (Parent Act)	List-II (Chapter of the Code)
A. EPF & MP Act 1952	1. Chapter VII
B. ESI Act 1948	2. Chapter III
C. Payment of Gratuity Act 1972	3. Chapter IV
D. Employees' Compensation Act 1923	4. Chapter V

(a) A-2 B-3 C-4 D-1 (b) A-1 B-2 C-3 D-4 (c) A-2 B-4 C-3 D-1 (d) A-2 B-3 C-1 D-4

Q. 32. Consider the following statements about the Code:

- 1 The Code consolidates 9 parent Acts.
- 2 It was brought into force on 21 November 2025.
- 3 It merged EPFO and ESIC into a single organisation.

Which of the above statements are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q. 33. Consider the following statements about substantive changes under the Code:

- 1 Gig workers and platform workers are new statutory categories.
- 2 The aggregator contribution at 1-2% of turnover is genuinely new.
- 3 Fixed-term employees are entitled to gratuity on 1 year of service, prorated.

Which of the above statements are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q. 34. Consider the following statements about what did NOT change under the Code:

- 1 EPF coverage threshold of 20 employees.
- 2 ESI wage ceiling of Rs 21,000.
- 3 Gratuity's 5-year continuous service condition for the general case.
- 4 Employees' Compensation two-year claim time limit.

How many of the above are correct?

(a) 1 (b) 2 (c) 3 (d) all four

Q. 35. Which one of the following statements is not correct?

(a) The Central Board of Trustees remains chaired by the Union Minister of Labour and Employment
(b) The Central Provident Fund Commissioner remains the chief executive of EPFO (c) The Code merged EPFO into a general Social Security Fund abolishing its separate identity (d) EPFO and ESIC continue as separate statutory bodies under the Code

Q. 36. The Central Government's contribution of 1.16% under the Code goes to

(a) EPF (b) EDLI (c) EPS (d) the Social Security Fund for gig workers

Q. 37. The Code's Chapter IX-X provisions on gig and platform workers include

(a) a compulsory contribution from platform workers themselves (b) an aggregator contribution at 1-2% of annual turnover, capped at 5% of amounts paid to workers, feeding a Social Security Fund
(c) a State subsidy to platform workers (d) an ESI-style medical benefit at 100% wages

Q. 38. A stem asks "under Chapter VII of the Code, what is the compensation for permanent total disablement?" The correct answer is

(a) 90% of wages as a monthly payment (b) 60% of monthly wages (capped at Rs 8,000) x Schedule IV factor, minimum Rs 1,40,000 (c) Rs 5 lakh cover (d) Rs 20 lakh maximum

Q. 39. The best summary of the Code's effect is

(a) it abolishes contributory social insurance in favour of universal benefits (b) it is more consolidation than reform - most substantive numbers survive; the genuine novelties are gig/platform workers and the aggregator contribution (c) it merges EPF, ESI and gratuity into a single benefit (d) it repeals all pre-existing labour statutes

Q. 40. The exam habit for "under the Code..." questions is

(a) always assume everything has changed (b) identify the parent Act the question is actually about and answer with the pre-Code rule unless the question specifically references a Code innovation (c) always answer as though the Code has not yet been enacted (d) treat Code and pre-Code as synonyms with no distinction

5. Answers and Explanations

5.1 Level 1

Q	Ans	Explanation
1	b	9 parent Acts
2	c	21 November 2025
3	c	8 May 2026
4	c	EPF, EPS and EDLI
5	d	Employees' Compensation
6	c	Chapters IX-X
7	b	20 - unchanged
8	c	Rs 21,000 - unchanged
9	a	1 - no minimum, unchanged
10	d	Rs 20 lakh (since 2018-19, unchanged)
11	b	Preserved with the same death/disablement exception
12	b	Annual turnover - the F3.8 conceptual breakthrough
13	b	Fewer than 2 surviving children ; 12 weeks for 2 or more
14	b	Rs 8,000 - unchanged
15	c	Rs 1,20,000 (Rs 1,40,000 for PTD)

5.2 Level 2

Q	Ans	Explanation
16	d	None of these changed. EPF threshold, ESI ceiling and gratuity 5-year rule all preserved
17	b	Aggregator contribution - genuinely new. The others predate the Code
18	b	Still 20. The 50 is only the s.16 co-operative-society exception
19	b	Consolidation, not reform of the numbers. The Code's work was primarily architectural
20	c	Industrial Disputes Act 1947 - that is consolidated into the Industrial Relations Code, not the Social Security Code
21	a	Employment information / career centres - a form of employment-related service that fits alongside social security
22	d	Chapter VIII
23	b	Advisory - to recommend and review schemes
24	b	Carried over into Chapter IX , plus Chapters IX-X's new gig/platform provisions
25	b	CGIT as EPF Appellate Tribunal, then High Court under Article 226 - unchanged from the 1952 Act
26	c	High Court on a substantial question of law under s.30 - one of the five appellate architectures, unchanged
27	b	1-2% of construction cost - unchanged
28	a	Section 3's twin phrases ("arising out of and in the course of") and Schedule III's three-part structure are preserved
29	b	5 years for the general case; 1 year prorated for fixed-term employees

Q	Ans	Explanation
30	a	All the ESI substance is preserved - threshold, ceiling, contribution rates, benefits, machinery

5.3 Level 3

Q	Ans	Explanation
31	a	A-2 EPF → Chapter III ; B-3 ESI → Chapter IV ; C-4 Gratuity → Chapter V ; D-1 Employees' Compensation → Chapter VII
32	a	1 and 2 only. Statement 3 is FALSE - EPFO and ESIC continue as separate statutory bodies
33	d	All three correct - the three most examinable genuine innovations under the Code
34	d	All four are correct. These four items are the paper's favourite trap: all preserved
35	c	(c) is FALSE. The Code did NOT merge EPFO or abolish its identity. It consolidates the statute, not the organisation
36	c	EPS - unchanged
37	b	Aggregator contribution 1-2% of turnover, cap 5% of payments - the F3.8 finding
38	b	60% x monthly wages (Rs 8,000 cap) x Schedule IV factor, minimum Rs 1,40,000 - the s.4 formula preserved under Chapter VII
39	b	Consolidation with genuine novelty limited to gig/platform - the interview answer
40	b	Identify the parent Act, answer with the pre-Code rule unless a Code innovation is specifically involved - the exam habit that saves time

6. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F3.10 - CODE CONSOLIDATED AND MASTER NUMBERS

THE CODE ON SOCIAL SECURITY 2020 consolidates **9 PARENT ACTS** · in force **21 November 2025** · Central Rules **8 May 2026** · **NOT 13 Acts** (that is OSH's total); **NOT 4** (that is Wages) **NINE ACTS** EC 1923 · ESI 1948 · EPF & MP 1952 · Employment Exchanges 1959 · Maternity Benefit 1961 · Gratuity 1972 · Cine-Workers Welfare Fund 1981 · BOCW Cess 1996 · Unorganised Workers 2008

CHAPTERS OF THE CODE

- 1 **III = EPF, EPS, EDLI** (F3.2, F3.3)
- 2 **IV = ESI** (F3.5)
- 3 **V = Gratuity** (F3.7)
- 4 **VI = Maternity** (F3.7 outline)
- 5 **VII = Employees' Compensation** (F3.6)
- 6 **VIII = Building/construction workers, cess** (F2.7)
- 7 **IX-X = Unorganised, gig, platform workers** (F3.8)

WHAT CHANGED - the smaller list

- 1 **Gig and platform workers introduced** as statutory categories
- 2 **Aggregator contribution 1-2% of turnover, capped 5%** - genuinely new
- 3 **Fixed-term employees' gratuity at 1 year prorated** (from IR Code)
- 4 Uniform definitions of employee and wages
- 5 Harmonised registration (Shram Suvidha)
- 6 Inspector-cum-Facilitator terminology
- 7 Penalty escalation for repeats
- 8 Employment exchanges renamed career centres
- 9 Some appellate/deposit provisions harmonised within Chapter III

WHAT DID NOT CHANGE - the more important list

- 1 **EPF threshold STILL 20 · ceiling STILL Rs 15,000 · rates 12% + 8.33/3.67 + 0.50 + 0.50 + CG 1.16%**
- 2 **ESI threshold STILL 10 · ceiling STILL Rs 21,000 (Rs 25,000 disability) · rates 0.75 + 3.25 = 4%**
- 3 **ESI SIX BENEFITS unchanged:** medical (day 1, in kind), sickness 70% for 91 days (78 qualifying), maternity 100% for 26 weeks, disablement 90%, dependants' 90%, funeral Rs 15,000
- 4 **Gratuity threshold STILL 10 · 5-year rule PRESERVED · formula 15 days/26 x years · maximum Rs 20 lakh**
- 5 **Maternity 26 wks / 12 wks / 12 wks (adoption) UNCHANGED**
- 6 **EC threshold STILL 1 · wage cap Rs 8,000 · death 50% · PTD 60% · min Rs 1,20,000/1,40,000 · 2-year claim limit · s.3 twin phrases · Schedule III 3-part structure**
- 7 **BOCW cess STILL 1-2% of construction cost**
- 8 **Section 7A power, section 45A power - both preserved substantively**
- 9 **The FIVE appellate architectures - all preserved**

INTERVIEW ANSWER on the Code's significance: "More consolidation than reform - most substantive numbers survive; the genuine novelties are gig/platform workers, the aggregator contribution and some uniform definitions."

TRAP QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

- 1 "EPF threshold raised to 50" → NO, still 20; 50 is co-op-society-without-power exception
- 2 "Gratuity payable after 1 year" → ONLY for fixed-term; general rule still 5 years
- 3 "EC Act repealed" → NO, substance carried into Chapter VII; not "abolished"
- 4 "EPFO merged into ESIC" → NO, both continue as separate bodies

MASTER NUMBERS - COMPRESSED

Thresholds: EPF 20 · ESI 10 · Gratuity 10 · Maternity 10 · EC 1 · Co-op no-power 50 · BOCW 10 · CLRA 20 · Migrant 5 · Creche 50

Ceilings: EPF Rs 15,000 · ESI Rs 21,000 (Rs 25,000 disability) · EC wage cap Rs 8,000 · Gratuity max Rs 20 lakh · PM-SYM income Rs 15,000 · NPS-Traders turnover Rs 1.5 crore · ELI salary Rs 1 lakh

Rates: EPF 12 + 12 (8.33/3.67) + 0.50 + 0.50 + CG 1.16 · EPF interest **8.25%** · ESI 0.75 + 3.25 = 4 · Aggregator 1-2% turnover (cap 5%) · BOCW cess 1-2% · PM-SYM/NPS-Traders 50:50 · Reduced EPF 10% · Bonus 8.33-20%

Formulas: $EPS = (PS \times PSvc) / 70 + 2yr \text{ bonus at } 20+$ · **EC death** = 50% × wages(cap 8000) × SchIV, min 1,20,000 · **EC PTD** = 60% × wages(cap 8000) × SchIV, min 1,40,000 · **EC temp** = 25% half-monthly, max 5 yrs · **Gratuity** = (wages/26) × 15 × years, max 20 lakh · **14B** = 5/10/15/25% by default length, max 100%

Times: EPF 7A ex parte 3 months · 7B review 45 days · 7C escaped 5 yrs · 7-I 60+60 · 7-O 75% · 7Q 12% · EPS vest 10 yrs, super 58, early 50 · EC claim 2 yrs · EC deposit 1 month · Gratuity payment 30 days · Gratuity appeal 60+60 · ESI sick 70% for 91 days (78 qualifying) · Maternity 26/12/12 wks (80 days qualifying) · PMJJBY lien 45 days · APY/PM-SYM ages 18-40 · PMSBY 18-70 · PMJJBY 18-50

Lump sums: EC death min 1,20,000 · EC PTD min 1,40,000 · Gratuity max 20L · ESI funeral 15,000 · ESI confinement 5,000 · PMJJBY/PMSBY 2 lakh · PMJJBY Rs 436 · PMSBY Rs 20 · PM-SYM/NPS-Traders 3,000/mo · APY 1K-5K · PM-JAY 5 lakh/family/yr · EPS min 1,000 · NSAP 200/300/500 · NFBS 20,000 · ELI Part A 15,000 · ELI Part B 3,000/mo

FIVE APPELLATE ARCHITECTURES: EPF → CGIT (EPF Appellate Tribunal) → Art 226 · ESI → EI Court · EC → High Court s.30 · Gratuity → Appellate Authority → Art 226 · Maternity → Inspector/internal → Art 226

MODULE 3 COMPLETE. Nine chapters, one Master Numbers Table, and every ILO contingency accounted for.

7. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F3.10 - CODE + MASTER NUMBERS

CODE: 9 ACTS · IN FORCE 21 NOV 2025 · RULES 8 MAY 2026

Chapters: III EPF · IV ESI · V Gratuity · VI Maternity · VII EC · VIII BOCW · IX-X

Unorganised/Gig/Platform

NEW: gig/platform workers · aggregator levy 1-2% turnover cap 5% · fixed-term gratuity at 1 yr · Inspector-cum-Facilitator · career centres

UNCHANGED: EPF 20 · ESI 10 (Rs 21K) · EPF Rs 15K · 12% + 12% + CG 1.16% · Gratuity 5 yrs · Maternity 26 wks · EC threshold 1 · EC wage cap Rs 8,000 · 5 appellate architectures

INTERVIEW ANSWER: more consolidation than reform

TRAPS: EPFO NOT merged · EPF threshold NOT 50 · gratuity general rule STILL 5 yrs · EC Act NOT repealed

MASTER NUMBERS AT A GLANCE

THRESHOLDS: EPF 20 · ESI 10 · Gratuity 10 · Maternity 10 · EC 1 · Co-op-no-power 50 · BOCW 10 · CLRA 20 · Migrant 5 · Creche 50

CEILINGS: EPF 15K · ESI 21K (25K disability) · EC cap 8K · Gratuity max 20L

EPF RATES: 12 + 12 (8.33/3.67) + EDLI 0.50 + Admin 0.50 + CG 1.16 · Interest 8.25%

ESI RATES: 0.75 + 3.25 = 4

AGGREGATOR: 1-2% of turnover, cap 5% of payments

BOCW cess: 1-2% of construction cost

EPS FORMULA: $(PS \times PSvc) / 70 \cdot +2 \text{ yrs if } \geq 20 \cdot \text{vest } 10 \text{ yrs} \cdot \text{super } 58 \cdot \text{min Rs } 1,000$

EC FORMULAS: Death 50%, min Rs 1.2L · PTD 60%, min Rs 1.4L · Temp 25% max 5 yrs

GRATUITY FORMULA: $(\text{wages}/26) \times 15 \times \text{years}$, max Rs 20L

14B DAMAGES: 5/10/15/25% by default length, cap 100%

TIMES: 7A ex-parte 3m · 7B 45d · 7C 5yrs · 7-I 60+60 · 7-O 75% · 7Q 12% · EC claim 2 yrs · Gratuity pay 30d · ESI sick 91d/78 qualifying · Maternity 26/12/12 wks, 80d qual · PMJJBY lien 45d

SUM ASSURED: PMJJBY/PMSBY Rs 2L · PMJJBY premium Rs 436 · PMSBY Rs 20 · PM-JAY Rs 5L per family/yr

PENSIONS: PM-SYM/NPS-Traders Rs 3,000 · APY Rs 1K-5K · IGNOAPS Rs 200/500 · IGNWPS Rs 300/500

FIVE APPELLATE ROUTES: EPF → CGIT → Art 226 · ESI → EI Court · EC → HC s.30 · Gratuity → AA → Art 226 · Maternity → internal → Art 226

MODULE 3 COMPLETE